Algorithms Composition Approach based on Difference Potentials Method for Parabolic Problems

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Abstract. In this work we develop an efficient and flexible *Algorithms Composition Approach* based on the idea of the difference potentials method (DPM) for parabolic problems in composite and complex domains. Here, the parabolic equation serves both as the simplified model, and as the first step towards future development of the proposed framework for more realistic systems of materials, fluids, or chemicals with different properties in the different domains. Some examples of such models include the ocean-atmosphere models, chemotaxis models in biology, and blood flow models. Very often, such models are heterogeneous systems - described by different types of partial differential equations (PDEs) in different domains, and they have to take into consideration the complex structure of the computational subdomains. The major challenge here is to design an efficient and flexible numerical method that can capture certain properties of analytical solutions in different domains, while handling the arbitrary geometries and complex structures of the subdomains. The Algorithms Compositions principle, as well as the Domain Decomposition idea, are one ways to overcome these difficulties while developing very efficient and accurate numerical schemes for the problems. The *Algorithms Composition Approach* proposed here can handle the complex geometries of the domains without the use of unstructured meshes, and can be employed with fast Poisson solvers. Our method combines the simplicity of the finite difference methods on Cartesian meshes with the flexibility of the Difference Potentials method. The developed method is very well suited for parallel computations as well, since most of the computations in each domain are performed independently of the others.

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Key words: Parabolic equation, heat equation, finite difference, difference potentials methods, Cartesian meshes, complex and composite domains, curvilinear boundaries, algorithms composition, and domain decomposition.

1. Introduction

In this work we develop an efficient and flexible *Algorithms Composition Approach* based on the idea of the difference potentials method (DPM) for parabolic problems in composite and complex domains. Here, a parabolic equation (2.1) serves both as the simplified model, and as the first step towards future development of the proposed scheme for more realistic systems of materials, fluids, or chemicals with different properties in the different domains/or in the different parts of the domains. Some examples of such models include the ocean-atmosphere models, chemotaxis models in biology, and blood flow models (see for example [1, 12, 23, 7, 6, 15, 14]).

Numerical approximations and modeling of many physical, biological, and biomedical problems often deal with heterogeneous models (described by different types of partial differential equations (PDEs) in different domains), and/or they have to take into consideration the complex structure of the computational subdomains. The major challenge here is to design an efficient and flexible numerical method that can capture certain properties of analytical solutions in different domains/subdomains (such as positivity, different regularity/smoothness of the solutions in the domains/subdomains, etc), while handling the arbitrary geometries and complex structures of the domains. *The Algorithms Compositions principle, as well as the Domain Decomposition idea, are one way to overcome these difficulties while developing very efficient and accurate numerical schemes for the problems.* This methodology can be used within any discretization for PDEs (such as finite differences, finite volumes, finite elements, or spectral methods). It provides great opportunities to subdivide problems into subproblems, and to design the most suitable numerical approximation for each of them independently. After that, one can compose the problems and algorithms together by imposing some interface conditions. Such schemes can be used for parallel computations as well, since most of the computations in each subdomain are performed independently of the others (see for example, [13, 21]).

In this work, we will consider the heat equation (2.5) in an arbitrary composite domain in 2D, and we will further develop, as well as numerically test the *Algorithms Composition Scheme* proposed originally in [20, 18] for linear elliptic problems. The *Algorithms Composition Approach* developed in this paper is an accurate, simple, and robust scheme of algorithms composition for the numerical approximations of the boundary value problems in composite and complex domains. The proposed method can handle complex geometries without the use of unstructured meshes (with the consideration of only regular Cartesian grids), and can be employed with fast Poisson solvers. Our method combines the simplicity of the finite difference methods on Cartesian meshes with the flexibility of the Difference Potentials method [19].

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The main advantages of our *Algorithms Compositions Approach* are: (i) our method provides the flexibility to consider a non-difference approximation of the boundary and interface (or matching) conditions, which automatically takes into account the smoothness of the solution. Such self-tuning is impossible, for example, in the difference or finite-element approximations of these conditions; (ii) the proposed approach also avoids the difficulties associated with the computation of the solutions in arbitrary domains (no need for the generation and use of unstructured meshes, or the need to design the schemes for the unstructured meshes); (iii) the numerical schemes, as well as meshes can be chosen totally independently for each subdomain/domain; (iv) the total complexity of the developed algorithm reduces to the several solutions of simple auxiliary problems on structured Cartesian grids; (v) the proposed approach can be further developed and combined with other methods such as high-order finite difference, finite-volume, or finite element methods; (vi) since the schemes for constructing the solutions in each domain/subdomain are independent of each other, our approach is very well suited for parallel computations.

The paper is organized as follows. First, in Section 2 we give some preliminaries that will be helpful for the introduction of the proposed algorithm. Then, we introduce the idea of Difference Potentials Method (DPM) for the parabolic equation in the single domain, and we make an overview of the important properties of the (DPM) method for the model under consideration in Section 2.1. In Section 3, we develop the *Algorithms Composition Scheme* for the parabolic model in a composite domain using the flexibility of the (DPM) method. In Section 4, we state the main steps of the proposed algorithm. Finally, we illustrate the flexibility and performance of the proposed scheme in several numerical experiments in Section 5. Some concluding remarks are given in Section 6.

2. Preliminaries

In this section, we will introduce some preliminaries that will be helpful for the discussions in the following sections. We are concerned in this paper with the parabolic initial and boundary value problem (IVP) in some bounded domain $\overline{\Omega} \subset \Omega^0 \subset \mathrm{R}^2$, and its neighborhood Ω^0 over the time interval $[0, T]$.

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + Lu = q \text{ in } \Omega \times (0, T), \tag{2.1}$$

$$l(u) = \psi \text{ on } \partial\Omega \times (0, T), \tag{2.2}$$

$$u|_{t=0} = u_0 \text{ in } \Omega. \tag{2.3}$$

Here, $q(x_1, x_2, t)$ is the given smooth source function in the domain Ω^0, and L is the second order linear symmetric elliptic differential operator

$$Lu := -\sum_{i,j=1}^{2} \frac{\partial}{\partial x_i}(a_{ij}(\mathbf{x})\frac{\partial u}{\partial x_j}) + a_0 u, \tag{2.4}$$

where coefficients a_0 and a_{ij} are assumed to be sufficiently smooth functions in Ω^0, $a_{ij}(\mathbf{x}) = a_{ji}(\mathbf{x}), \quad (i, j) = 1, 2$ for almost every $\mathbf{x} := (x_1, x_2) := (x, y) \in \Omega^0$. Moreover, there exists a constant $\alpha_0 > 0$ such that $\sum_{i,j=1}^{2} a_{ij}(\mathbf{x})\xi_i\xi_j \geq \alpha_0|\xi|^2$ for each $\xi \in \mathrm{R}^2$, and for almost every $\mathbf{x} \in \Omega^0$. The classical example of the above parabolic problem (2.1) is the heat equation

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} - \Delta u = q. \tag{2.5}$$

Below, to simplify the presentation of the ideas we will be concerned with the heat equation (2.5) subject to (2.2) - (2.3). However, let us mention that the same idea can be extended in a straightforward way to a general parabolic equation (2.1).

Next, at the given time t, we denote by $\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ the Cauchy data of an arbitrary continuous piecewise smooth function $\mathbf{v}(x, y, t)$ defined on Γ and in some of its neighborhoods:

$$\mathbf{v}_\Gamma := \Big(\mathbf{v}\Big|_\Gamma, \frac{\partial \mathbf{v}}{\partial n}\Big|_\Gamma\Big). \tag{2.6}$$

Here, $\frac{\partial}{\partial n}$ is the inward (with respect to Ω) normal derivative to Γ, and $\Gamma := \partial\Omega$ is a piecewise smooth boundary of Ω.

Now, in order to introduce our ideas, let us consider model problem (2.5) in its time-discrete form. To this end, we subdivide time interval $[0, T]$ into N_t time steps, and denote by $t^i := i\Delta t, \quad \Delta t > 0$. Setting $m := \frac{1}{\Delta t}$ and considering the Backward Euler method, we obtain below the following time discrete reformulation of the parabolic equation (2.5) in some domain $\widetilde{\Omega} \subset \Omega^0$.

Let us introduce

$$L_{\Delta t}[u^{i+1}] := \Delta u^{i+1} - m u^{i+1}, \quad (x, y) \in \widetilde{\Omega}, \tag{2.7}$$

where $L_{\Delta t}$ denotes the linear elliptic operator applied to u^{i+1}.
We also denote the right-hand side as:

$$G^u_{\Delta t} := -q^{i+1} - m u^i, \quad (x, y) \in \widetilde{\Omega}, \tag{2.8}$$

where $q^{i+1} := q(x, y, t^{i+1})$.

Then the semi-discrete formulation of the model (2.5) is stated as follows:

Find some $u^{i+1} := u^{i+1}(x, y) \approx u(x, y, t^{i+1})$ such that

$$L_{\Delta t}[u^{i+1}] = G^u_{\Delta t}, \quad (x, y) \in \widetilde{\Omega}, \tag{2.9}$$

Remark: For each i this is a time-independent elliptic problem.

Let us now introduce the auxiliary problem. For the purposes of the discussion below, we will suppress for now the explicit dependence on the time level i. We place the original domain Ω in the auxiliary domain $\Omega^0 \subset \mathbb{R}^2$: $\bar{\Omega} \subset \Omega^0$. Next, we will formulate a discrete in time and continuous in space *Auxiliary Problem (AP):*

Definition 2.1. *For any given right-hand side $G_{\Delta t}$ find F such that,*

$$L_{\Delta t}[F] = G_{\Delta t}, \quad (x, y) \in \Omega^0, \tag{2.10}$$

$$F = 0, \quad (x, y) \in \partial\Omega^0, \tag{2.11}$$

where $L_{\Delta t}$ is the same linear elliptic operator as in (2.9) and is applied here to F. Since the auxiliary domain Ω^0 can be arbitrary, we can choose it to be a square. The above *(AP)* Dirichlet problem is uniquely solvable.

Remark: This is a continuous in space Dirichlet problem for each fixed time level.

Let us now construct a potential with a density $\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$. Define the vector function

$$\mathbf{v}_\Gamma := (\phi^0(s), \phi^1(s)), \tag{2.12}$$

where $\phi^0(s)$ and $\phi^1(s)$ are two piecewise smooth continuous functions on $|\Gamma|$ that are $s-$periodic with a period of $|\Gamma|$, s is the arc length along $|\Gamma|$, and $|\Gamma|$ is the length of the boundary. Here, the arc length is chosen as a parameter only for definiteness.

Let $v(x, y) = v_{\Omega^0}$ be an arbitrary sufficiently smooth function on Ω^0 that satisfies condition (2.11) on $\partial\Omega^0$: $v|_{\partial\Omega^0} = 0$. Assume that its Cauchy data $\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ is defined as in (2.6) and is equal to the vector function $\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ in (2.12). Then, we can recall the following definition of the potential $P_{\Omega\Gamma}\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ below [18, 19].

Definition 2.2. *A Potential $u_\Omega := P_{\Omega\Gamma}\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ defined on Ω with density $\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ is equal on Ω to the solution of (AP, Def. 2.1), with the right hand-side $G_{\Delta t}$ defined as follows:*

$$G_{\Delta t} := \begin{cases} 0, & (x, y) \in \Omega, \\ L_{\Delta t}[v], & (x, y) \in \Omega^0 \backslash \Omega \end{cases} \tag{2.13}$$

It can be shown that at each time level the above potential $u_\Omega := P_{\Omega\Gamma}\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ is well-defined: it depends only on Cauchy data (2.12), but is independent of the choice of a particular function $v(x, y)$ satisfying (2.11) on $\partial\Omega^0$ whose Cauchy data coincides with (2.12). For a more detailed discussion on the potentials with projectors, see [18, 19].

Remark: The potential $u_\Omega := P_{\Omega\Gamma}\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ can be viewed as the modification [16] of the Calderon potential [2]. However, in comparison to the Calderon potential, the potential $P_{\Omega\Gamma}\mathbf{v}_\Gamma$ admits a finite-dimensional constructive approximation by Difference Potentials [19, 7, 6], as will be illustrated below in Section 2.1.

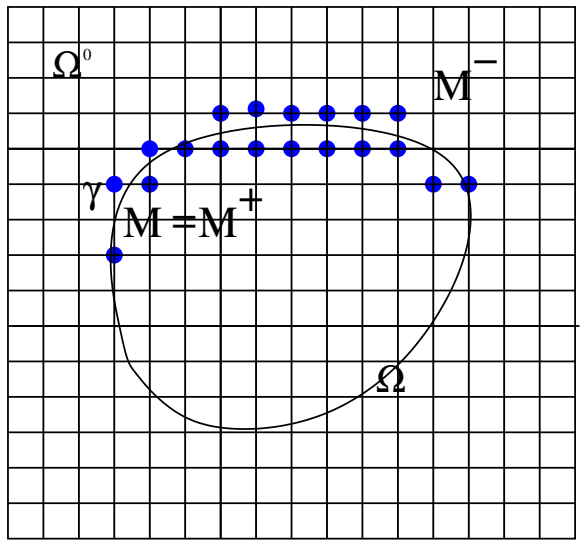

Fig. 2.1: Example (a sketch) of the auxiliary domain Ω^0, original domain Ω; the example of some points (x_j, y_k) in the set γ: the points which are outside Ω are from γ_{ex}, the points which are inside Ω are from $\gamma_{in} \in M$

2.1. Scheme Based on the Difference Potentials

We will develop our *Algorithms Composition Approach* based on the idea of the Difference Potentials Method (DPM) [19, 18, 20, 7, 6]. Difference Potentials Method (DPM) can be viewed as the method of building and computing the discrete parts of the modified Calderon's potentials. The DPM method on its own, or in combination with other numerical methods, is an efficient tool for the numerical solution of the interior and exterior boundary value problems in arbitrary domains (see for example, [19, 10, 17, 22, 20, 18, 7, 6]). Viktor S. Ryaben'kii originally introduced DPM in his Doctor of Science thesis (Habilitation thesis) in 1969. The DPM allows one to reduce uniquely solvable and well-posed boundary value problems into pseudo-differential boundary equations.

We will present in this Section the necessary preliminaries and some overview of the numerical scheme based on the difference potentials for the single arbitrary domain $\Omega \in \mathrm{R}^2$. This discussion will be important for the development of our approach for the composite/complex domain $\Omega \in \mathrm{R}^2$, which we will present in Sections 3 - 5.

At this point, let us assume that we consider (2.5) in some domain Ω - an arbitrary bounded domain in $\mathbb{R}^2$ with the boundary $\partial\Omega$. First, let us introduce some preliminary notations and definitions that will be used in this section. Denote $\Pi_{SR} v_R$ as the extension operator of function v from set/domain R to the set/domain S, π_S as the restriction operator to the set/domain S, $w_S := \pi_S w$ as the restriction of function w to the set/domain S, and χ_S as the characteristic function of the set S.

Next, we introduce here the auxiliary fully discrete problem. Let us place the original domain Ω in the auxiliary domain $\Omega^0 \subset \mathbb{R}^2$. The choice of the domain Ω^0 should be convenient for the computations, so we will choose it to be a square, and we will introduce a Cartesian mesh for Ω^0, with points $x_j = j\Delta x, y_k = k\Delta y \quad (k, j = 0, \pm 1, ...)$. Let us assume for simplicity that $\Delta x = \Delta y := h$. Let us also define a five-point stencil $N_{j,k}$ with its center placed at (x_j, y_k) to be the set of the following points: $N_{j,k} := \{(x_j, y_k), (x_{j\pm 1}, y_k), (x_j, y_{k\pm 1})\}$.
In addition, we also introduce point sets $M := M^+ := (x_j, y_k) \in \Omega$ - the sets of all the points (x_j, y_k) that belong to the interior of the original domain Ω. We now define $N := N^+ := \{\bigcup_{j,k} N_{j,k} | (x_j, y_k) \in M\}$- the set of all points covered by five-point stencils when center point (x_j, y_k) of the stencil goes through all the points of the set M. Note that the points in the set N will be both inside and outside of the original domain Ω.
Now, let us introduce the grid boundaries $\gamma_{ex} := \gamma_{ex} = N \backslash M$- the exterior grid boundary layer for domain Ω, $\gamma_{in} := \{(x_j, y_k) | (x_j, y_k) \in M : N_{j,k} \not\subset M\}$ - the interior grid boundary layer for domain Ω, and define $\gamma := \gamma_{ex} \cup \gamma_{in}$ - a narrow set of nodes that surrounds the continuous boundary $\partial\Omega$, Figure 2.1.

Next, we construct the auxiliary set M^1 by completing the set N to a rectangle, and adding one extra layer of grid points to each side of the rectangle, hence $N \subset M^1$. Also, as before, define $N^1 := \{\cup_{j,k} N_{j,k} | (x_j, y_k) \in M^1\}$, and finally, let us introduce $\gamma^1 := N^1 \backslash M^1$.

We can now introduce the space approximation of (2.9) and consider the fully discrete version of equation (2.5). Therefore, the computed quantity will be the point values $u_{j,k}(t) \approx u(x_j, y_k, t)$. We denote by $u^i_{j,k}$ the computed $u_{j,k}(t^i)$: $u^i_{j,k} :\approx u_{j,k}(t^i)$ at the discrete time level $t^i := i\Delta t$, with time step Δt. Additionally, we denote by $\Delta_{j,k}$ the discrete Laplacian obtained using second order central difference formulas for the x and y variables, and by

$$L_{\Delta t,h}[u^{i+1}] := \Delta_{j,k} u^{i+1} - m u^{i+1}_{j,k}, \quad (x_j, y_k) \in \Omega^0. \tag{2.14}$$

Finally, we denote by $g^u_{j,k}$,

$$g^u_{j,k} := -q^{i+1}_{j,k} - m u^i_{j,k}, \tag{2.15}$$

where as before, $q^{i+1}_{j,k} \equiv q(x_j, y_k, t^{i+1})$ is the value of the source function $q(x_j, y_k, t)$ at t^{i+1}.

Thus, the fully discrete finite-difference based version of the parabolic equation (2.5) is
Find some $u^{i+1}_{j,k}$ such that it satisfies

$$L_{\Delta t,h}[u^{i+1}] := g^u_{j,k}, \quad (x_j, y_k) \in \Omega^0. \tag{2.16}$$

Again, as in the "Preliminaries" in Section 2, we will suppress for now the explicit dependence on the time level i for the clarity of the discussion. Based on a central finite difference approximation (2.16), we will now formulate the fully discrete analog of the auxiliary problem *(AP)*, Def. 2.1 in Section 2 - the *Discrete Auxiliary Problem (DAP)*:

Definition 2.3. *For the given grid function g, find the solution of the scheme f such that:*

$$L_{\Delta t,h}[f] = g_{j,k}, \quad (x_j, y_k) \in M_1, \tag{2.17}$$

$$f_{j,k} = 0, \quad (x_j, y_k) \in \gamma^1, \tag{2.18}$$

where, as before in (2.14), $L_{\Delta t,h}[f] \equiv \Delta_{j,k} f - m f_{j,k}$. We note that the ((*DAP*), Def. 2.3) is well defined for any right hand side $g_{j,k}$ - it has a unique solution f defined on the set N^1.
Also, it should be noted that the solution of ((*DAP*), Def. 2.3) can be efficiently computed using the Fast Fourier Transform (FFT) with the appropriate choice of the auxiliary set M^1.

We now introduce a linear space V_γ of all the grid functions $\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ defined on γ, similar to [18, 7, 6, 19]. We will extend by zero the value of $\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ to other points of the grid N^1. Let us now recall that,

Definition 2.4. *A Difference Potential [18, 7, 6, 19] with the given density $\mathbf{v}_\gamma \in V_\gamma$ is the grid function $u := \mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ defined on the set N, which coincides (on the set N) with the solution of ((DAP), Def. 2.3) when the right hand-side is defined as follows:*

$$g_{j,k} := \begin{cases} 0, & (x_j, y_k) \in M, \\ L_{\Delta t,h}[\mathbf{v}_\gamma], & (x_j, y_k) \in M^1 \backslash M. \end{cases} \tag{2.19}$$

The Difference Potential can be viewed as the discrete analog of the modified potential of Calderon's type, or as the discrete analog of the space-continuous potential, Def. 2.2 in Section 2 (similar to Def. 2.4, the definition of *Difference Potential* can be extended by considering the set $M^1 \backslash M$ as the "interior" set, and set M as the "exterior" one, [19]). Here, $\mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}$ denotes the operator that constructs the difference potential $u = \mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ from the given density $\mathbf{v}_\gamma \in V_\gamma$. The operator $\mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}$ is the linear operator of density $\mathbf{v}_\gamma$, and it can be easily constructed (see for example [7, 6, 19]). Again, for our problem, $L_{\Delta t,h}[\mathbf{v}_\gamma] \equiv \Delta_{j,k}\mathbf{v}^\gamma - m\mathbf{v}^\gamma_{j,k}$.

As in the space-continuous case, (Def. 2.2, Section 2), at each time level the concept of the difference potential is well-defined due to the following statement:

Theorem 2.5. *The difference potential $\mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ depends only on $\mathbf{v}_\gamma \in V_\gamma$, but is independent of the choice of the function v defined on N^1 (satisfying condition (2.18) on $\gamma^1 : v_{j,k} = 0, (x_j, y_k) \in \gamma^1$), and coinciding*

with $\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ *on* γ*:* $v|_\gamma \equiv Tr_\gamma v = \mathbf{v}_\gamma$. Let us recall the proof for the reader's convenience (for the general proof and discussion, see [19, 20, 18]).

Proof: Let us define the sets $N^+ := N$, $\Omega^- := \Omega^0 \backslash \Omega$, $M^- := (x_j, y_k) \in \Omega^-$, and $N^- := \{\bigcup_{j,k} N_{j,k} | (x_j, y_k) \in M^-\}$. Recall that, π_{N^+} denotes the restriction operator to the set $N := N^+$, $\Pi_{N^1\gamma} v_\gamma$ is the arbitrary extension v_γ to N^1, and χ_{M^-} is the characteristic function of set M^-.

Let us notice now that the difference potential, Def. 2.4, can be represented in the following operator form:

$$u = \mathbf{P}_{N^+\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma = \pi_{N^+} L^{-1}_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{M^-} L_{\Delta t,h}[\mathbf{v}_\gamma]],$$

where $\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ is extended by zero outside of set γ to $N^1 \backslash \gamma$. Now, let us represent the arbitrary function z, defined on N^1, such that: $z = \Pi_{N^1\gamma} v_\gamma$, as the sum of the three terms

$$z = \chi_{N^1\backslash N^+} z + \chi_{N^1\backslash N^-} z + \mathbf{v}_\gamma.$$

Notice that, for the first term $\chi_{M^-} L_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{N^1\backslash N^+} z] = L_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{N^1\backslash N^+} z]$, and for the second term $\chi_{M^-} L_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{N^1\backslash N^-} z] = 0$. From this we obtain that

$$\pi_{N^+} L^{-1}_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{M^-} L_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{N^1\backslash N^+} z]] = \pi_{N^+} L^{-1}_{\Delta t,h}[L_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{N^1\backslash N^+} z]] = 0.$$

Hence, the only remaining contribution to the potential u is the contribution from the third term :

$$u \equiv \mathbf{P}_{N^+\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma = \pi_{N^+} L^{-1}_{\Delta t,h}[\chi_{M^-} L_{\Delta t,h}[\mathbf{v}_\gamma]].$$

□

Next, let us recall [7, 6, 19] and define another operator $\mathbf{P}_\gamma : V_\gamma \to V_\gamma$ as the trace (or restriction) of the Difference Potentials $\mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ on the grid boundary γ: $\mathbf{P}_\gamma := Tr_\gamma \mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}_\gamma = \mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}_\gamma|_\gamma$. *We now state the important theorem for the further development of our scheme (see for example [19, 18].) The details of the general proof can be found in [19]*:

THEOREM 2.6. *At each time level* t^{i+1}*, density* $\mathbf{v}_\gamma \in V_\gamma$ *is the trace of some solution* $u := u_N \in N$ *:* $\mathbf{v}_\gamma = Tr_\gamma u_N \equiv u_\gamma$ *to the homogeneous equation*

$$L_{\Delta t,h}[u] = 0, \quad (x_j, y_k) \in M \tag{2.20}$$

if and only if we have

$$Q_\gamma \mathbf{v}_\gamma := \mathbf{v}_\gamma - \mathbf{P}_\gamma \mathbf{v}_\gamma = 0, \quad (x_j, y_k) \in \gamma. \tag{2.21}$$

Moreover, the solution u_N *defined on the set* N *can be reconstructed from its boundary value* $\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ *using the formula* $u := \mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma$.

Remark: It can be shown that $\mathbf{P}_\gamma$ is the projector, hence $V_\gamma = Im\,\mathbf{P}_\gamma \oplus Ker\,\mathbf{P}_\gamma$.

Thus, Theorem 2.6 implies that the problem of finding a unique solution to (2.20), subject to the appropriate approximation of the boundary conditions on $\partial\Omega$ denoted by $l(u_\gamma) = \psi_\gamma$, in other words the problem:

$$L_{\Delta t,h}[u] = 0, \tag{2.22}$$

$$l(u_\gamma) = \psi_\gamma, \tag{2.23}$$

is equivalent to the problem of finding the unique density function $\mathbf{v}_\gamma \equiv u_\gamma$ from the system of the *Boundary Equations*:

$$Q_\gamma \mathbf{v}_\gamma = 0, \tag{2.24}$$

$$l(\mathbf{P}_{\mathbf{N}\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma) = \psi_\gamma, \tag{2.25}$$

After that, at each time level the solution u_N to (2.22)-(2.23) is reconstructed from $u_N = \mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma$.

Remark: The approximation (2.23) will depend on values at the points $(x_j, y_k) \in \gamma$. Let us also note that the equation (2.24) can be viewed as the generalized Poincaré-Steklov interface equation.

From the above discussion and, in particular, from Theorem 2.6 and from (2.24) - (2.25), the next result follows:

PROPOSITION 2.7. *At each time level t^{i+1}, the approximation u_N to the solution u of the (IVP) problem (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3) in domain $\overline{\Omega}$ can be obtained as*

$$u_N = \mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma + \bar{u}_N, \tag{2.26}$$

$$l(\mathbf{v}_\gamma + \bar{\mathbf{u}}_\gamma) = \psi_\gamma, \tag{2.27}$$

where $\bar{u}_N$ is the approximation of any particular solution to the inhomogeneous equation (2.5) in $\bar{\Omega}$, at the given time level t^{i+1}. $\mathbf{P}_{N\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ is the difference potentials in $\bar{\Omega}$ at the same time level t^{i+1}, with a density $\mathbf{v}_\gamma$ that satisfies equation (2.24): $Q_\gamma \mathbf{v}_\gamma = 0$. Equation (2.27) denotes the approximation of the boundary condition $l(u) = \psi$ on $\partial\Omega$, and is the consequence of the equality (2.26) and (2.24). Finally, $\bar{\mathbf{u}}_\gamma := Tr_\gamma \bar{u}_N$.

Remark: Let us mention that in (2.26), we can consider any particular solution: Let $\bar{u}_N$ be some solution to $L_{\Delta t,h}[\bar{u}_N] = g^u_{j,k}, (x_j, y_k) \in M$. We extend the solution arbitrarily to N^1, and we will apply operator $L_{\Delta t,h}$ to the extended solution $\bar{u}_{N^1}$. Hence, we will get the right-hand side of the equation $L_{\Delta t,h}[\bar{u}_{N^1}] = g$, which coincides on M with g^u. For example, we can construct the particular solution $\bar{u}_N$ as follows:

DEFINITION 2.8. *Define, $\bar{u}$ to be the solution f of the auxiliary problem (DAP, Def. 2.3) with the right hand-side defined as*

$$g_{j,k} := \begin{cases} g^u_{j,k}, & (x_j, y_k) \in M, \\ \tilde{g}^u_{j,k}, & (x_j, y_k) \in M^1 \backslash M \end{cases} \tag{2.28}$$

where $g^u_{j,k}$ is given in (2.15) and $\tilde{g}^u_{j,k}$ is some extension of $g^u_{j,k}$ to $M^1 \backslash M$. Set $\bar{u}_N := \pi_N \bar{u}$.
This point will be discussed in more details in Section 5.

Remark: Finally, let us comment briefly about the accuracy in space of the approximation $u_N = \mathbf{P}_{N_\gamma}\mathbf{v}_\gamma + \bar{u}_N$ in (2.26)-(2.27), to the solution u of (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3). One would expect that the solution u_N will converge to the continuous solution u in the discrete Hölder norm of order $q + \epsilon$ (with the arbitrary $0 < \epsilon < 1$), with the rate $O(h^{p-\epsilon})$ as $h \to 0$. Here, p is the order of the accuracy of the approximation of the continuous differential operator $L_{\Delta t}$ by the discrete operator $L_{\Delta t,h}$ (we assume that the boundary condition (2.2) is approximated by (2.27) with the same or a higher order than p). Hence, for the central finite difference scheme that is discussed here, we will expect the $O(h^2)$ rate in the maximum norm in space. For a more detailed and general discussion, and the proof of the accuracy of the (DPM) method, the reader can consult [19, 11].

Remark: Let us emphasize that one could develop any other numerical approximation in space (such as high-order finite difference, finite-volume, finite element methods) for (2.1) within the presented framework of the potentials and of the difference potentials but for our goals in this paper, we will consider the second order finite-difference approximation for the model equation (2.5).

3. Algorithms Composition Approach based on the Difference Potentials Method

We will now develop, as well as numerically test the *Algorithms Composition Approach* for a parabolic model under consideration (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3).

We start the introduction of the scheme, and the illustration of the ideas, by considering the system (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3) (or formulation (2.9) in its time-discrete form) in some composite domain $\overline{\Omega}$. $\overline{\Omega}$ is an arbitrary bounded domain in $\mathbb{R}^2$ with the boundary $\partial\Omega$, and such that it consists of two disjoint subdomains Ω_1 and Ω_2: $\overline{\Omega} = \overline{\Omega}_1 \cup \overline{\Omega}_2$, $\Gamma = \overline{\Omega}_1 \cap \overline{\Omega}_2$, with piecewise smooth boundaries $\Gamma_1 := \partial\Omega_1 \cup \Gamma$ and $\Gamma_2 := \partial\Omega_2 \cup \Gamma$ (see Figure 3.1). We would like to also emphasize that the two subdomains are considered here only for the simplicity of the presentation. The discussed idea can be extended in a straightforward way to multiple subdomains or composite domains.
Our goal at each time level t^{i+1} is to find an approximations to u^{i+1} in domain Ω:

$$u^{i+1}_\Omega := \begin{cases} u^{i+1}_{\Omega_1}, (x, y) \in \Omega_1, \\ u^{i+1}_{\Omega_2}, (x, y) \in \Omega_2, \end{cases} \tag{3.1}$$

where $u^{i+1}_{\Omega_p}$ (here $p = 1, 2$) are the solutions to (2.9) in each subdomain Ω_p:

$$L_{\Delta t}[u^{i+1}_{\Omega_p}] = G^{u_{\Omega_p}}_{\Delta t}, \quad (x, y) \in \Omega_p, \text{ and } (p = 1, 2). \tag{3.2}$$

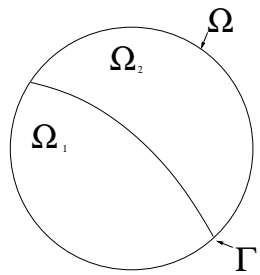

Fig. 3.1: Sketch of domain Ω with boundary $\partial\Omega$, two subdomains Ω_1, Ω_2, and the interface Γ.

Solution u_Ω^{i+1} is subject to the appropriate boundary conditions on the boundary $\partial\Omega$ of the original domain

$$l(u_\Omega^{i+1}) = \psi^{i+1}, \tag{3.3}$$

and to the interface conditions on the interface boundary Γ, which we will select to be the following:

$$l_\Gamma(u_{\Omega_1}^{i+1}, u_{\Omega_2}^{i+1}) := \begin{cases} u_{\Omega_1}^{i+1} = u_{\Omega_2}^{i+1}, & (x,y) \in \Gamma, \\ \nabla u_{\Omega_1}^{i+1} \cdot n_\Gamma = \beta \nabla u_{\Omega_2}^{i+1} \cdot n_\Gamma, & (x,y) \in \Gamma. \end{cases} \tag{3.4}$$

Here, n_Γ is a unit outward normal vector to the interface boundary Γ (with respect to Ω_1). To develop our idea, we will consider the difference potentials scheme (2.26) - (2.27) from Section 2.1 (which uses Backward Euler in time and central finite difference space discretization) as the fully discrete approximation of (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3) in each subdomain Ω_p, and we will build an algorithm for the approximation of u_Ω^{i+1} in (3.1) based on the algorithms composition idea. As before, we will remove below the explicit dependance on time for the clarity of the presentation.

First, as we have done in (Section 2.1) for the single domain Ω, we will introduce auxiliary difference problems for each subdomain $\Omega_p, (p = 1, 2)$: we will place each of the original subdomains Ω_p in the auxiliary domains $\Omega_p^0 \subset \mathbb{R}^2, (p = 1, 2)$. As before, the choice of each domain Ω_p^0 should be convenient for computations, and the choice of these auxiliary domains do not need to depend on each other. Again, for each subdomain, we will proceed in a similar way as we did in (Section 2.1). For each Ω_p^0 we will introduce, for example, a Cartesian mesh (again the choice of the meshes for the auxiliary problems in each subdomain can be totally independent. The choice for each subdomain is based on the considerations of the efficiency and simplicity of the resulting discrete problems.) After that, all the definitions, notations, and properties introduced in (Section 2.1) extends to each subdomain Ω_p in a direct and straightforward way: we will use index $p, (p = 1, 2)$ to distinguish each subdomain.

The cornerstone of our approach is the following proposition, which is a consequence of Proposition 2.7 in Section 2.1 for a single domain.

Proposition 3.1. *At each time level t^{i+1}, the fully discrete approximation u_{N_p} to the solution u_{Ω_p}, $(p = 1, 2)$ in (3.2) - (3.4) is obtained as*

$$u_{N_p} = \mathbf{P}_{N_p\gamma_p}\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} + \bar{u}_{N_p}, \tag{3.5}$$

$$l(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1} + \bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2} + \bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_2}) = \psi_{\gamma_1,\gamma_2}, \tag{3.6}$$

$$l_\Gamma(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1} + \bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2} + \bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_2}) = \phi_{\gamma_1,\gamma_2}, \tag{3.7}$$

where $\bar{u}_{N_p}$ is the approximation of the particular solution to the inhomogeneous equation (2.5) in each subdomain $\overline{\Omega_p}$ at the given time level t^{i+1}. $\mathbf{P}_{N_p\gamma_p}\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ is the Difference Potentials with a density $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ in each domain $\overline{\Omega_p}$ at the same time level t^{i+1}. Expressions in (3.6)-(3.7) denote the approximations of the boundary and interface conditions, respectively, on the continuous boundaries $\partial\Omega_1, \partial\Omega_2$, and interface boundary Γ (in other words on the boundaries Γ_1 and Γ_2), where $\bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_p} = Tr_{\gamma_p}\bar{u}_N$. These approximations will depend on the values of $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}$, $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2}$, and/or $\bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_1}$, $\bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_2}$ at the points of the set γ_1 and γ_2. The construction of (3.6)-(3.7) will be discussed in more detail in Section 3.2. Density/trace $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ in the equation (3.5) ranges over the solution of the *Boundary Equation* on each discrete grid boundary set γ_p:

$$Q_{\gamma_p}\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \equiv \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} - \mathbf{P}_{\gamma_p}\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} = 0, \tag{3.8}$$

see (2.24) in Section 2.1. However, there are multiple solutions $(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2})$ to (3.8), and as before, the unique pair of the densities/traces $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1} \in V_{\gamma_1}$ and $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2} \in V_{\gamma_2}$ will satisfy the above *Boundary Equation* (3.8), as well as the boundary and interface conditions (3.6) - (3.7).

3.1. System of Boundary Equations: Weak Formulation

At each time level, the unique pair of the densities/traces $(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2}) \equiv (Tr_{\gamma_1} u_{N_1}, Tr_{\gamma_2} u_{N_2}) \in V_{\gamma_1} \times V_{\gamma_2}$ of the approximation (3.5)-(3.7) is the unique solution to the *Boundary Equation* (3.8), subject to the boundary and interface conditions (3.6) - (3.7). There are different ways to solve (3.8) subject to (3.6) - (3.7). One possibility is to consider directly the original formulation (3.8) and employ finite difference approximation of the boundary and interface conditions (3.6) - (3.7) (see for example [7, 19] for more details on this approach). However, to avoid the difficulties associated with the finite difference approximations of (3.6) - (3.7) in arbitrary domains, we will take advantage of the weak formulation of (3.8) and the spectral approximation of the Cauchy data.

To define a weak formulation, let us first introduce the discrete norm for the space of grid functions $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \in V_{\gamma_p}$. Similar to [18], we will consider the following norm:

$$||\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}||^2_{V_{\gamma_p}} := h\Big[\sum |\mathbf{v}_\nu|^2 + \alpha \sum \Big|\frac{\mathbf{v}_{\nu_1+1,\nu_2} - \mathbf{v}_\nu}{h}\Big|^2 + \alpha \sum \Big|\frac{\mathbf{v}_{\nu_1,\nu_2+1} - \mathbf{v}_\nu}{h}\Big|^2\Big], (p = 1, 2). \tag{3.9}$$

Here, the sum is extended over all $\nu := (\nu_1, \nu_2) \in \gamma_p$ for the first term in (3.9), over all $\nu := (\nu_1, \nu_2)$ that, together with $(\nu_1 + 1, \nu_2)$ belong to γ_p in the second term of (3.9), and over all $\nu := (\nu_1, \nu_2)$ that, together with $(\nu_1, \nu_2 + 1)$ belong to γ_p in the third term of (3.9). α is a nonnegative coefficient which will be defined in the numerical experiments.

Remark: The norm (3.9) is the discrete analog of the continuous norm for the Cauchy data $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} \in V_{\Gamma_p}$:

$$||\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p}||^2_{V_{\Gamma_p}} := \int_{\Gamma_p} \Big[|v^0_p(s)|^2 + \alpha\Big(\Big|\frac{dv^0_p(s)}{ds}\Big|^2 + |v^1_p(s)|^2\Big)\Big] ds \tag{3.10}$$

Let us introduce $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} \in \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_p}$ as a finite dimensional approximation of the continuous Cauchy data $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} \in V_{\Gamma_p}$: $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} :\approx \mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p}$, and $\tilde{V}_{\Gamma_p}$ as the finite dimensional subspace of V_{Γ_p}. The details on the construction of the approximation $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}$ will be presented in Section 3.2. Finally, let us also introduce

Definition 3.2. *Let $\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}$ be the operator that, to every $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} \equiv (v^0_p(s), v^1_p(s))$ from the space of continuous Cauchy data V_{Γ_p}, assigns $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ from the space of the discrete densities V_{γ_p}, $(p = 1, 2)$:*

$$\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} = \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p} \mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p}, \tag{3.11}$$

Moreover, we have from Def. 3.2 that for $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} \in \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_p}$, we can define $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p} \in V_{\gamma_p}$ to be:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p} := \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p} \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} \tag{3.12}$$

The exact form of the operator $\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}$ will be given in (3.22) - (3.23) in Section 3.2 as well.

Therefore, the weak formulation of the *Boundary Equations* (3.8) subject to (3.6)-(3.7) is formulated as follows:

Definition 3.3.

At each time level, find $(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2}) \equiv (\tilde{u}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{u}_{\Gamma_2}) \in \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_1} \times \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_2}$ that minimizes the functional

$$||l(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1} + \tilde{\bar{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2} + \tilde{\bar{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_2}) - \psi||^2_\Phi + ||l_\Gamma(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1} + \tilde{\bar{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2} + \tilde{\bar{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_2}) - \phi||^2_\Phi + \sum_{p=1}^{2} ||Q_{\gamma_p}\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}||^2_{V_{\gamma_p}}, \tag{3.13}$$

where $||\cdot||_\Phi$ is the Hilbert norm, $\tilde{V}_{\Gamma_1}$, and $\tilde{V}_{\Gamma_2}$ are finite dimensional subspaces of V_{Γ_1} and V_{Γ_2}, respectively, and $(\tilde{\bar{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\bar{\mathbf{u}}}_{\mathbf{\Gamma_2}})$ are the finite dimensional approximations of $(\bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\Gamma_1}, \bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\Gamma_2})$ (it is a pair of the Cauchy Data of the particular solution $(\bar{u}_{N_1}, \bar{u}_{N_2})$). This finite dimensional approximation is discussed in Section 3.2.

Therefore, at each time level, the unique pair of the densities/traces $(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2}) \in V_{\gamma_1} \times V_{\gamma_2}$ of the approximation (3.5)-(3.7) to the solution (3.1) of (2.5), (2.2)-(2.3) in the composite domain Ω is obtained as the approximation:

$$(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2}) \approx (\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_2}) = (\Pi_{\gamma_1\Gamma_1}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1}, \Pi_{\gamma_2\Gamma_2}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2}). \tag{3.14}$$

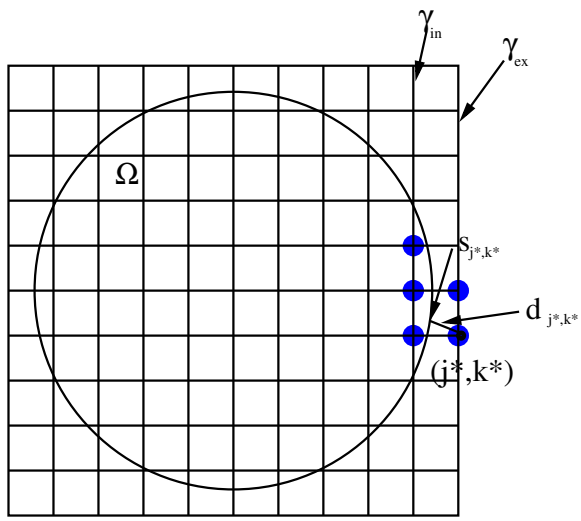

Fig. 3.2: *Example (a sketch) of the geometry with the curve boundary Ω; point $(x_j^\star, y_k^\star)$ is in the set $\gamma_{ex} \in M$, $d_{j*,k*}$ is the distance from this point to the boundary of the domain Ω, and $s_{j^\star,k^\star}$ is the corresponding arc length.*

3.2. System of Boundary Equations: Discretization of the Cauchy Data

As before, we will assume that the solution is given at a fixed time level and we will suppress the explicit dependence on time for the clarity of the presentation.

1. As we already showed in Sections 3 - 3.1, at each time level, the problem of finding the approximation to the unique solution $u_\Omega := (u_{\Omega_1}, u_{\Omega_2})$ of the model (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3) in composite domain $\overline{\Omega} \equiv \overline{\Omega_1} \cup \overline{\Omega_2}$ reduces to the problem of finding the unique pair of the densities/traces $(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2}) \equiv (u_{\gamma_1}, u_{\gamma_2}) \in V_{\gamma_1} \times V_{\gamma_2}$ (3.14). This pair of the densities/traces satisfies the generalized Poincaré-Steklov interface equations (3.8), as well as the boundary and interface conditions (3.6) - (3.7).

2. After that, the approximation of the solution $(u_{\Omega_1}, u_{\Omega_2})$ of (2.5), (2.2)-(2.3) in $\bar{\Omega}$ is reconstructed from the approximated densities $(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_2}) \in V_{\gamma_1} \times V_{\gamma_2}$ using the pair of difference potentials $(\mathbf{P}_{N_1\gamma_1}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{P}_{N_2\gamma_2}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_2})$, see equation (3.5).

In order to solve for the unknown densities/traces in Step 1 above, we will consider a weak formulation Def. 3.3, Section 3.1, and we will employ a spectral approach for the approximation (3.14) of $(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_2})$ as elaborated below.

Consider a set of basis functions on the curve boundaries Γ_1 and Γ_2:

$$\phi_1(s), ..., \phi_L(s), \text{ and } \phi_1^\star(s), ..., \phi_L^\star(s) \tag{3.15}$$

where s is the arc length and L is the total number of the basis functions. We will consider here the same basis functions on all parts of the boundaries, although in general, the basis functions can be selected differently for the different parts of the boundaries. In general, this choice will depend on the smoothness of the boundary of the domains and on the smoothness of the solution.
Next, we will assume that for every sufficiently smooth single-valued periodic function $f(s)$ defined on the boundaries Γ_1 and Γ_2, the sequence

$$\epsilon_L := \min_{u_{pl}^0, u_{pl}^1} \int [|f(s) - \sum_{l=1}^{L} u_{pl}^0 \phi_l(s)|^2 + |f'(s) - \sum_{l=1}^{L} u_{pl}^1 \phi_l^\star(s)|^2] ds \tag{3.16}$$

tends to zero with increasing L: $\lim \epsilon_L = 0$ as $L \to \infty$.

Therefore, we will employ the following approximation to construct finite-dimensional $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} \in \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_p}$:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} := \sum_{l=1}^{L} (u_{pl}^0 \phi_l + u_{pl}^1 \phi_l^\star), \tag{3.17}$$

that discretize the elements $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} \in V_{\Gamma_p}$ from the space of continuous Cauchy Data on the boundary Γ_p, $p = 1, 2$:

$$\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} := (v_p^0(s), v_p^1(s)), \tag{3.18}$$

and we have

$$\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} :\approx \mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p}. \tag{3.19}$$

In (3.17), $\phi_l \equiv (\phi_l, 0)$ is the set of basis functions for the first component of the Cauchy data $v^0(s)$, and $\phi_l^\star \equiv (0, \phi_l^\star)$ is the set of basis functions for the second component of the Cauchy data $v^1(s)$, $l = 1, ...L$. In our numerical experiments, we will consider the same set of basis functions for both components $\phi_l \equiv \phi_l^\star$. The coefficients (u_{pl}^0, u_{pl}^1) with $p = 1, 2$ and $l = 1, ...L$, are the unknown expansion coefficients that need to be determined.

To obtain the approximation of the discrete densities/traces $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}, (p = 1, 2)$ at the points $(x_j, y_k) \in \gamma_p$, we will consider the following Taylor expansion:

$$\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \equiv u_{N_p}(x_j, y_k)|_{\gamma_p} = v_p^0(s_{j,k}) + d_{j,k} v_p^1(s_{j,k}) + O(d_{j,k}^2). \tag{3.20}$$

Here, $s_{j,k}$ is the value of the arc length s at the point where the continuous boundary Γ_p intersects the normal constructed from the point $(x_j, y_k) \in \gamma_p$ to Γ_p. The parameter $d_{j,k}$ is the shortest distance from $(x_j, y_k) \in \gamma_p$ to the intersection point $s_{j,k}$ of the normal with Γ_p. $d_{j,k}$ is taken with the plus sign if $(x_j, y_k) \in \overline{\Omega_p}$, and with a minus sign if $(x_j, y_k) \notin \Omega_p$, see Figure 3.2. Thus, we have

$$\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \approx v_p^0(s_{j,k}) + d_{j,k} v_p^1(s_{j,k}). \tag{3.21}$$

Let us recall the operator $\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p}$, Def. 3.2, Section 3.1 that assigns $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$, $(p = 1, 2)$ to every $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} \equiv (v_p^0(s), v_p^1(s))$ from the space of continuous Cauchy data. We will construct such an operator $\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p}$ according to the above Taylor formula (3.21), hence:

$$\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \approx \Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p} \mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p}, \tag{3.22}$$

$$\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p} \mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} := v_p^0(s_{j,k}) + d_{j,k} v_p^1(s_{j,k}). \tag{3.23}$$

For example, if $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} = (v_p^0(s), 0)$, then we have that $\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p} \mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} = v_p^0(s_{j,k})$. Similarly, if $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} = (0, v_p^1(s))$, then the action of the operator $\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p}$ is given as $\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p} \mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} = d_{j,k} v_p^1(s_{j,k})$. Thus, we have the following finite-dimensional approximation for the discrete density $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \in V_{\gamma_p}$:

$$\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \approx \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p} = \Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p} \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} = \sum_{l=1}^{L} \left(u_{pl}^0 (\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p} \phi_l) + u_{pl}^1 (\Pi_{\gamma_p \Gamma_p} \phi_l^\star) \right), \quad (p = 1, 2) \tag{3.24}$$

where $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p}$ is as defined previously in (3.12), Section 3.1.

It follows that the approximation of the density/trace $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ is the function of the unknown coefficients u_{pl}^0 and u_{pl}^1 which need to be determined. Once the expansion coefficients u_{pl}^0 and u_{pl}^1 are obtained, the density $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p} \approx \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} \equiv u_{\gamma_p}$ is reconstructed using formula (3.24).

3.3. System of Boundary Equations: Discretization of the Potential and Discrete Variational Formulation

As we showed in Section 3, densities/traces $(\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1}, \mathbf{v}_{\gamma_1})$ range over the solutions of the *Boundary Equation* (3.8) on each discrete grid boundary set (γ_1, γ_2). Therefore, using the above approximation (3.24) for $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ in the system of *Boundary Equations* (3.8), we will obtain the system of linear equations with $|\gamma_p|$ equations for $2L$ unknowns $\mathbf{u}_p^0 := (u_{p1}^0, ..., u_{pL}^0)$, $\mathbf{u}_p^1 := (u_{p1}^1, ..., u_{pL}^1)$:

$$B_p^0 \mathbf{u}_p^0 + B_p^1 \mathbf{u}_p^1 = 0, \quad (p = 1, 2). \tag{3.25}$$

Here, $|\gamma_p|$ is the total number of points in the set γ_p $(p = 1, 2)$ and (u^0_{1l}, u^1_{1l}), (u^0_{2l}, u^1_{2l}) are the unknown expansion coefficients of $(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2})$ (3.19). Matrices B^0_p and B^1_p are defined as $B^0_p := (\mathbf{b}^0_{p1}, ..., \mathbf{b}^0_{pL})$ and $B^1_p := (\mathbf{b}^1_{p1}, ..., \mathbf{b}^1_{pL})$. Here, columns $\mathbf{b}^0_{pl}$ and $\mathbf{b}^1_{pl}$ are $|\gamma_p|$ dimensional vectors whose components are computed as the values at the points of the set $|\gamma_p|$ of the grid functions $Q_{\gamma_p}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi_l]$ and $Q_{\gamma_p}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi^\star_l]$, respectively. These values of the grid functions

$$Q_{\gamma_p}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi_l] \equiv \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi_l - \mathbf{P}_{N_{\gamma_p}}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi_l]$$

and

$$Q_{\gamma_p}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi^\star_l] \equiv \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi^\star_l - \mathbf{P}_{N_{\gamma_p}}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi^\star_l]$$

are known and obtained by constructing $2L$ difference potentials: let us recall that the difference potential $u_{N_p} = \mathbf{P}_{N_{\gamma_p}}\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ (Def. 2.4, Section 2.1) can be easily constructed in general. The operator $\mathbf{P}_{N_{\gamma_p}}$ is the linear operator of the density $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$. Here, the difference potential

$$\mathbf{P}_{N_{\gamma_p}}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi_l], \text{ or } \mathbf{P}_{N_{\gamma_p}}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi^\star_l]$$

is constructed by solving the simple auxiliary problem ((*DAP*), Def. 2.3), with the right-hand side given in (2.19), where density $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$ is set to:

$$\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} := \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi_{l^\star}, \text{ for } (x_j, y_k) \in \gamma_p, \tag{3.26}$$

or to

$$\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p} := \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\phi^\star_{l^\star}, \text{ for } (x_j, y_k) \in \gamma_p, \tag{3.27}$$

with fixed $l^\star$ that takes the values from 1 to L. Let us note that for the detailed discussion on the general construction of the difference potential, one may refer to [19, 7].

Notice that the linear system (3.25) will be the overdetermined linear system since we have to have $|\gamma_p| > L$ for the accurate resolution of the density $\mathbf{v}_{\gamma_p}$. Finally, let us define

$$G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}) := ||Q_{\gamma_p}[\Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}]||^2_{V_{\gamma_p}} = ||B^0_p\mathbf{u}^0_p + B^1_p\mathbf{u}^1_p||^2_{V_{\gamma_p}}, \quad (p = 1, 2) \tag{3.28}$$

Therefore, at each time level t^{i+1} we have the following discrete variational formulation of (3.13):

Definition 3.4. *Find the unique weak solution pair* $(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2}) \in \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_1} \times \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_2}$ *for which the constants* (u^0_{1l}, u^1_{1l}) *and* (u^0_{2l}, u^1_{2l}) *with* $l = 1, ..., L$ *minimize the functional:*

$$||l(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_2}) - \psi||^2_\Phi + ||l_\Gamma(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_2}) - \phi||^2_\Phi + \sum_{p=1}^{2} G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}). \tag{3.29}$$

Here, $\tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_p}$ is equal to $\tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_p} := \sum_{l=1}^{L}(\bar{u}^0_{pl}\phi_l + \bar{u}^1_{pl}\phi^\star_l)$, and the coefficients $(\bar{u}^0_{pl}, \bar{u}^1_{pl})$ are obtained using the values of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_p}$ at the points of the set γ_p, in other words using $\bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_p} \approx \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\mathbf{\Gamma_p}}$. The values $\bar{\mathbf{u}}_{\gamma_p}$ are known values since the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_p}$ is constructed as the solution of the simple auxiliary problem ((*DAP*, Def. 2.3), Section 2.1) (for more details see the *Remark* and Def. 2.8 after Proposition 2.7 in Section 2.1, as well as discussion in Section 5). Formulation (3.29) is the well-known least-square problem.

4. Algorithm

In this section, we will give brief summary of the important steps of the *Algorithms Composition Scheme* for the model problem (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3) in the arbitrary composite domain $\bar{\Omega} = \bar{\Omega}_1 \cup \bar{\Omega}_2$. As it was derived in Sections 3.1 - 3.3, our algorithm will be based on the discrete variational formulation (3.29). The overall complexity of the method reduces to the several solutions of simple auxiliary problems on regular Cartesian meshes (no need for the generation and storage on the unstructured meshes; no need for the design of the schemes on the unstructured meshes). Moreover, the selection of the auxiliary problems and meshes for each domain Ω_p is totally independent of each other, and is done based on the idea of the simplicity and efficiency of the resulting numerical scheme.

Therefore, we have the following steps at each time level:

1. Construct a discrete functional $G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}) \equiv ||B_p^0\mathbf{u}_p^0 + B_p^1\mathbf{u}_p^1||^2_{V_{\gamma_p}}$ for each domain $\Omega_p, (p = 1, 2)$. This functional is the weak formulation of the *Boundary Equation* (3.8) (note that the minimum of $G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p})$ gives an approximation to the Cauchy data of the general solution to the homogeneous parabolic equation in each subdomain).
   To build $G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p})$:
   - Select the auxiliary domain denoted here as Ω^0_{p,G_p}, and place the original domain Ω_p into the auxiliary domain for the computation and construction of $G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p})$, $(p = 1, 2)$. The choice of the auxiliary domain Ω^0_{p,G_p} should be convenient for computation, so we will choose it to be a square. Select Cartesian mesh $2^{n_p} \times 2^{n_p}$ for each of the auxiliary domains Ω^0_{p,G_p}, with n_p being a positive integer and $(p = 1, 2)$.
   - Recall that $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} \in \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_p}$ is the finite dimensional approximation of the continuous Cauchy data $\mathbf{v}_{\Gamma_p} \in V_{\Gamma_p}$ (see formula (2.6) in Section 2, as well as (3.19) in Section 3.2), and it is constructed using the set of the basis functions $\phi_l(s)$ for the first component of the Cauchy data, as well as the the set of the basis functions $\phi_l^\star(s)$ for the second component of the Cauchy data (formula (3.17), Section 3.1) : $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} := \sum_{l=1}^{L}(u^0_{pl}\phi_l + u^1_{pl}\phi_l^\star)$.
   - Construct matrices B_p^0 and B_p^1 for each domain. This construction reduces to the computation of the difference potentials (or to the solution of the simple auxiliary problems). If time step will not change during the simulations, then it will suffice to compute matrices B_p^0 and B_p^1 once and to store them. See details in Section 3.3.
   - Solve the overdetermined linear system (3.25) for the unknowns $\mathbf{u}_p^1 := (u^1_{p1}, ..., u^1_{pL})$ in terms of $\mathbf{u}_p^0 := (u^0_{p1}, ..., u^0_{pL})$ using the least squares method:

   $$B_p^0\mathbf{u}_p^0 + B_p^1\mathbf{u}_p^1 = 0, \quad (p = 1, 2),$$

   This step can be viewed as the construction of the Dirichlet to Neumann map: to each set $\mathbf{u}_p^0$ assign a set $\mathbf{u}_p^1$ that minimizes $G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p})$.
2. Next, choose the new auxiliary domain denoted as $\Omega^0_{p,\bar{u}_p}$ and place the original domain Ω_p into the auxiliary domain for the computation of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_p}, (p = 1, 2)$. As before, the choice of the auxiliary domain $\Omega^0_{p,\bar{u}_p}$ should be convenient for computation, so we will choose it to be a square. Select Cartesian mesh $2^{m_p} \times 2^{m_p}$ for the auxiliary domain $\Omega^0_{p,\bar{u}_p}$, where m_p is a positive integer. Find any particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_p}, (p = 1, 2)$ as the solution of the simple auxiliary problem (see *Remark* and see Def. 2.8 after Proposition 2.7 in Section 2.1, as well as the discussion at the beginning of Section 5). After that, calculate their Cauchy data on $\Gamma_p, (p = 1, 2)$.
3. Solve the joint discrete variational problem: find Cauchy data $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p} \in \tilde{V}_{\Gamma_p}, (p = 1, 2)$ that minimizes the functional (3.29), Section 3.3:

   $$||l(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_2}) - \psi||^2_\Phi + ||l_\Gamma(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_1}, \tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2} + \tilde{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{\Gamma_2}) - \phi||^2_\Phi + \sum_{p=1}^{2} G_p(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}).$$

4. Using the obtained Cauchy data $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}$, construct $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p} \approx \Pi_{\gamma_p\Gamma_p}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_p}$, Section 3.2. After that, extend the computed densities $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p}$ from the grid boundaries γ_p to the interior of each domain Ω_p by computing difference potentials $\mathbf{P}_{N_p}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p}$ in each domain Ω_p.
   At each time level reconstruct the desired approximation to the model (2.5), (2.2) - (2.3) in the composite domain $\bar{\Omega}$:

   $$u_{N_p} = \mathbf{P}_{N_p\gamma_p}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\gamma_p} + \bar{u}_{N_p}, \quad (p = 1, 2)$$

   (see Proposition 3.1 and equation (3.5) in Section 3.)

5. Numerical Examples

In this section, we demonstrate the performance of the proposed *Algorithms Composition Approach* on several test problems. In the numerical experiments below, we consider the set of the basis functions on

$\Gamma_p, (p = 1, 2)$ that is defined as:

$$\phi_{p,1}(s) = 1, \quad \phi_{p,2}(s) = \cos\left(\frac{2\pi}{|\Gamma|}s\right), \quad \phi_{p,3} = \sin\left(\frac{2\pi}{|\Gamma|}s\right), ...$$
$$\phi_{p,2N}(s) = \cos\left(\frac{2\pi}{|\Gamma|}Ns\right), \quad \phi_{p,2N+1} = \sin\left(\frac{2\pi}{|\Gamma|}Ns\right) \tag{5.1}$$

We assume that the sets $\phi \equiv \phi^\star$ in the numerical examples below. In all of the tests, we will consider the heat equation (2.5) in the composite domain $\bar{\Omega} \equiv \bar{\Omega}_1 \cup \bar{\Omega}_2$ as our model problem. Here, heat equation serves as the simplified model for more realistic systems of the materials, fluids, or chemicals with different properties in different parts of the domains (for example, the ocean-atmosphere models, chemotaxis models, or blood flow models [1, 12, 15, 14]). We consider equation (2.5) with the known analytical expressions for the exact solutions. This allows us to study the errors in the approximate solutions that will depend on the size of the auxiliary domains, mesh sizes, total number of the basis functions on Γ_p, etc.

Similar to [18], we will first define two functions

$$u^{(1)}(x, y) := \cos(x)\cos(y), \tag{5.2}$$

and

$$u^{(2)}(x, y) := \sin(c_1 x)\sin(c_2 y)P_5(\rho/0.9), \quad \rho = r/r_\Gamma(\theta). \tag{5.3}$$

Here, the Cartesian coordinates (x, y) of points are related to their polar coordinates (r, θ) as $(x, y) = (r\cos(\theta), r\sin(\theta))$. The interface boundary $\Gamma \equiv \Gamma_2$ of the domain Ω_2 is parametrically defined in polar coordinates (r, θ) by the relation $r(\theta) \equiv r_\Gamma(\theta) = 1 + 0.22\sin(k_\theta\theta)$, where k_θ is the parameter. See Figures 5.1 - 5.3 for the examples of the domains that are used in the numerical tests below.

The function $P_5(x)$ is continuous: identically equal to 1 for $x \le 0$; vanishes for $x \ge 1$ and, on the interval $0 \le x \le 1$, it is a unique ninth-degree polynomial whose derivatives up to the fourth order vanish at the endpoints of $0 \le x \le 1$:

$$P_5(x) := \begin{cases} 1, x \le 0, \\ 1 - 126x^5 + 420x^6 - 540x^7 + 315x^8 - 70x^9, 0 \le x \le 1, \\ 0, x \ge 1. \end{cases} \tag{5.4}$$

Let us note that due to the multiplier $P_5(\rho/0.9)$, the function $u^{(2)}$ (5.3) vanishes outside of Ω_2 and in a neighborhood of $\Gamma \equiv \Gamma_2$. At the same time, $u^{(2)}$ exhibits strong oscillations deep inside Ω_2.

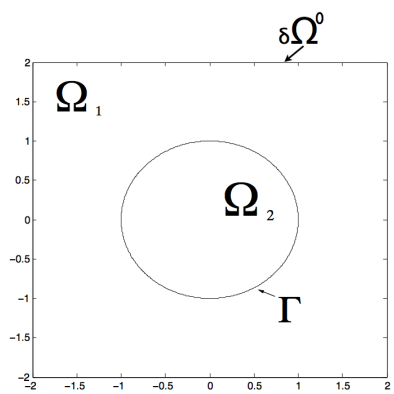

Fig. 5.1: Test Problem 1: Example of the auxiliary domain Ω^0, domains Ω_1 and Ω_2 and the boundary Γ of the domain Ω_2; parameter $k_\theta = 0$

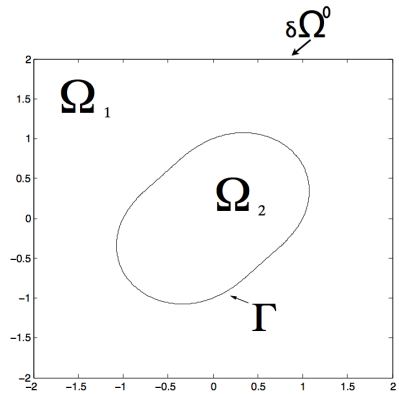

Fig. 5.2: Test Problem 2: Example of the auxiliary domain Ω^0, domains Ω_1 and Ω_2 and the boundary Γ of the domain Ω_2; $k_\theta = 2$

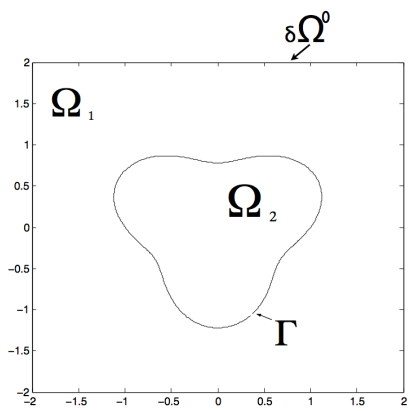

Fig. 5.3: Test Problem 3: Example of the auxiliary domain Ω^0, domains Ω_1 and Ω_2 and the boundary Γ of the domain Ω_2; $k_\theta = 3$

5.1. First Example

In the first example, we will construct our test problem with the analytical solution that is given as,

$$u(x,y,t) = \begin{cases} e^{-t}u_{\Omega_1}(x,y) = e^{-t}u^{(1)}, & (x,y) \in \Omega_1, \\ e^{-t}u_{\Omega_2}(x,y) = e^{-t}(u^{(1)} + u^{(2)}), & (x,y) \in \Omega_2, \end{cases} \tag{5.5}$$

with $c_1 = c_2 = 16$ in the formula (5.3). Thus, the solution $u(x,y,t)$ will exhibit strong oscillations inside the domain Ω_2 but none in the domain Ω_1. We consider three test problems, Figures 5.1 - 5.3 with $k_\theta = 0$ in the Test Problem 1 Figure 5.1; $k_\theta = 2$ in the Test Problem 2 Figure 5.2; and with $k_\theta = 3$ in the Test Problem 3, Figure 5.3.

We select $u(x,y,t)$ in (5.5) to be the exact solution for the heat equation (2.5), we set time step $dt = 1.e{-}6$ for all tests in Section 5.1, we use discrete norm (3.9) with $\alpha = 0.5$, and we consider time interval $[0, 0.01]$. In all experiments in this Section, we will choose the auxiliary domains

$$\Omega^0_{1,G_1} \equiv \Omega^0_{1,\bar{u}_{N_1}} := [-2,2] \times [-2,2],$$

for the construction of $G_1(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1})$, as well as for the computation of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_1}$ in Ω_1 (note that these auxiliary domains Ω^0_{1,G_1} and $\Omega^0_{1,\bar{u}_{N_1}}$ will coincide with the boundaries of the domain Ω_1, see Figures 5.1 - 5.3). At the same time, we will select the auxiliary domain

$$\Omega^0_{2,G_2} = [-1.6, 1.6] \times [-1.6, 1.6]$$

for the construction of the $G_2(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2})$, and we will choose the auxiliary domain

$$\Omega^0_{2,\bar{u}_{N_2}} = [-1.7, 1.7] \times [-1.7, 1.7]$$

for the approximation of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_2}$ in Ω_2. We will use the same Cartesian meshes

$$2^{n_1} \times 2^{n_1} \equiv 2^{n_2} \times 2^{n_2} \text{ with } n_1 \equiv n_2 = 9,$$

for the auxiliary domains Ω^0_{1,G_1} and Ω^0_{2,G_2} in the Tables 5.1 - 5.7. We will select Cartesian mesh

$$2^{m_1} \times 2^{m_1}$$

for the approximation of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_1}$ in $\Omega^0_{1,\bar{u}_{N_1}}$, as well as the Cartesian mesh

$$2^{m_2} \times 2^{m_2}$$

for the computation of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_2}$ in $\Omega^0_{2,\bar{u}_{N_2}}$, see Tables 5.1 - 5.6.
To compute the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_1}$ in $\Omega^0_{1,\bar{u}_{N_1}}$, we make the smooth extension $\tilde{g}^u_{j,k} \in \Omega^0_{1,\bar{u}_{N_1}} \backslash \Omega_1$ of the right-hand side $g^u_{j,k} = -q^{i+1} - u^i_{\Omega_1}$ (see Def. 2.8) outside of the domain Ω_1 (in other words we make smooth extension to the entire auxiliary domain/square Ω^0, see Figures 5.1 - 5.3). Similarly, to compute the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_2}$ in $\Omega^0_{2,\bar{u}_{N_2}}$ we make smooth extension of the right-hand side $g^u_{j,k} = -q^{i+1} - u^i_{\Omega_2}$ outside of the domain Ω_2 to the auxiliary domain $\Omega^0_{2,\bar{u}_{N_2}}$. We compute the $L_2(L_\infty)$ and $L_\infty(L_\infty)$ errors respectively:

$$Error_1 := (\sum_{i=0}^{N_t} \Delta t (\max_{(x,y)} |u^i_{calc} - u^i_{exact}|)^2)^{1/2},$$

and

$$Error_2 := \max_{(i=0,\ldots,N_t)} (\max_{(x,y)} |u^i_{calc} - u^i_{exact}|).$$

We observe a second order convergence for the space discretization for all three test problems from Tables 5.1 - 5.6. Also, there is not much difference in the results when we change the total number $2L$ of the basis functions for the approximation of the Cauchy data from $2L = 22$ to $2L = 30$. This is explained by the low dimension of the spaces of the Cauchy data $\mathbf{u}_\Gamma$ (2.6) of the exact solution u.

Finally, in the last Table 5.7 in this Section, we again consider the test Problem 3 with $2L = 22$, but we fix the mesh size $m_1 = 7$ for the construction of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_1}$ in the domain $\Omega^0_{1,\bar{u}_{N_1}}$, and we only vary the mesh size m_2. The accuracy of the results is not affected in comparison to the results presented in Tables 5.1-5.6 with $m_1 = m_2$. This is expected since the constant in the error for the space discretization depends on the maximum value of the fourth order spatial derivative of the exact solution. By the construction of the test problem (5.5), the constant in the error will be much larger for the solution u in the domain Ω_2 than for the solution u in the domain Ω_1. Thus, it will require a much finer mesh in the domain Ω_2 than in domain Ω_1. *This example illustrates the advantage of our algorithm composition approach since we have flexibility to use different meshes in the different parts of the domain, and to solve problems independently in each domain. This makes the numerical scheme much more computationally efficient and very suitable for parallel computations.*

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
7	0.00130		0.01523	
8	0.00032	4.06	0.00382	3.99
9	0.00008	4.00	0.00096	3.98

TABLE 5.1. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 22$; $k_\theta = 0$, Test problem* 1

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
7	0.00130		0.01523	
8	0.00032	4.06	0.00382	3.99
9	0.00008	4.00	0.00096	3.98

TABLE 5.2. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 30$; $k_\theta = 0$, Test problem* 1

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
7	0.00131		0.01534	
8	0.00033	3.97	0.00389	3.94
9	0.00008	4.13	0.00097	4.01

TABLE 5.3. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 22$; $k_\theta = 2$, Test problem* 2

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
7	0.00131		0.01534	
8	0.00033	3.97	0.00389	3.94
9	0.00008	4.13	0.00097	4.01

TABLE 5.4. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 30$; $k_\theta = 2$, Test problem* 2

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
7	0.00131		0.01540	
8	0.00033	3.97	0.00387	3.98
9	0.00008	4.13	0.00097	3.99

TABLE 5.5. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 22$; $k_\theta = 3$, Test problem* 3

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
7	0.00131		0.01540	
8	0.00033	3.97	0.00387	3.98
9	0.00008	4.13	0.00097	3.99

TABLE 5.6. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 30$; $k_\theta = 3$, Test problem* 3

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
7	0.00131		0.01540	
8	0.00033	3.97	0.00387	3.98
9	0.00008	4.13	0.00097	3.99

TABLE 5.7. *Errors as functions of the mesh size m_2; $m_1 = 7$ is fixed. number of the basis functions $2L = 22$; $k_\theta = 3$, Test problem* 3

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
8	0.00001		0.00020	
9	$2.5e-6$	4.0	0.00005	4.0

TABLE 5.8. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 22$; $k_\theta = 3$, $\alpha = 0.5$, Test problem* 3

	$L_2(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio	$L_\infty(L_\infty)$ error of $u(x,y)$	Ratio
8	0.00001		0.00020	
9	$2.5e-6$	4.0	0.00005	4.0

TABLE 5.9. *Errors as functions of the mesh size $m_1 = m_2$; number of the basis functions $2L = 22$; $k_\theta = 3$, $\alpha = 1.0$, Test problem 3*

5.2. Second Example

As the second test problem we will again consider the heat equation (2.5), but with the exact solution given below:

$$u(x,y,t) = \begin{cases} 100tu_{\Omega_1}(x,y) = 100tu^{(1)}, & (x,y) \in \Omega_1, \\ 100tu_{\Omega_2}(x,y) = 100t(u^{(1)} + u^{(2)}), & (x,y) \in \Omega_2. \end{cases} \tag{5.6}$$

We consider here $c_1 = c_2 = 4$ in (5.3). The function $u^{(2)}$ is much less oscillatory now than the one in the previous Section 5.1.

As before, we set time step $dt = 1.e-6$ for all tests in Section 5.2, and we consider the same time interval $[0, 0.01]$. Here, for the construction of the $G_1(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1})$, as well as for the computation of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_1}$ we will choose the same auxiliary domains (as in the Section 5.1)

$$\Omega^0_{1,G_1} \equiv \Omega^0_{1,\bar{u}_{N_1}} := [-2,2] \times [-2,2].$$

However, we will select the auxiliary domain

$$\Omega^0_{2,G_2} = [-1.5, 1.5] \times [-1.5, 1.5],$$

for the construction of the $G_2(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2})$, and we will consider the auxiliary domain

$$\Omega^0_{2,\bar{u}_{N_2}} = [-1.6, 1.6] \times [-1.6, 1.6],$$

for the computation of the particular solution $\bar{u}_{N_2}$. We will use the Cartesian meshes

$$2^{n_1} \times 2^{n_1} \equiv 2^{n_2} \times 2^{n_2} \text{ with } n_1 \equiv n_2 = 10$$

for the domains Ω^0_{1,G_1} and Ω^0_{2,G_2}, and we will select two different discrete norms (3.9) with $\alpha = 0.5$ and $\alpha = 1.0$ for the construction of the $G_1(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_1})$ and $G_2(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}_{\Gamma_2})$. The results are reported in Table 5.8 ($\alpha = 0.5$) and in Table 5.9 ($\alpha = 1.0$). As demonstrated, the results are not affected by the choice of α. The errors that are reported in Tables 5.8 - 5.9 are smaller than the ones in Tables 5.1 - 5.6. This is again expected due to the less oscillatory behavior of the function $u^{(2)}$ in (5.6), and due to the choice of the auxiliary problems.

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6. Concluding Remarks

In this work, we developed an efficient and flexible *Algorithms Composition Approach* based on the idea of the difference potentials method (DPM) for parabolic problems in composite and complex domains. We illustrated the accuracy, efficiency, and flexibility of our method in several numerical examples. The parabolic equation served as the simplified model here, and the first step towards future development of the proposed scheme for more realistic models of materials, fluids, or chemicals with different properties in the different domains.

Some of the future investigation will include the extension and further development of the proposed scheme to problems in physics and biology (see for example [7, 6, 23, 15, 14], [1, 3, 4]), as well as the development of the space discretization based on the high-order finite difference (see for example [11]), finite-volume (see for example [9], [5, 7, 6]), and finite element methods (see for example [8]) within the proposed algorithms composition framework.

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